ultimately wholesale and retail cloth markets was severely impacted by demonetization, with most of the workers being sent back home as farmers and factory owners did not have enough cash to reimburse them.

Some of their stories.

- 'About 30 vehicles with cotton come to our mill every day,' said Mukesh Patel, who runs the ginning facility at Pashupati Mills in Ahmedabad. 'On January 6, we had only five vehicles coming to sell cotton. The highest number we have seen after demonetization is 15… Farmers accept only cash as they have to pay their farm labour in cash,' said Patel. 'Cashless does not work there.' Patel is worried as his factory, which used to run 24 hours a day for four months, will now work only for 12 hours a day for eight months, since he will now receive cotton from farmers at a slow pace, over a longer period. 'My labour costs will be double this year, and my operational overheads will rise,' said Patel. 'This year, we don't have any option, do we?'[31]
- For the struggling saree weavers in Banaras, demonetization has come as a fatal blow. Decline in business coupled with withdrawal limits have led to a cash crunch and they aren't able to pay labourers or procure raw materials to run their businesses. 'What will my family eat, if I use up the little cash I have managed to get to purchase raw materials?' asks weaver Akhlaq Ahmed, 48, who has three daughters. He has stopped his business as he struggles to recover his dues.[32]
- Bhiwandi, Maharashtra, holds more than a sixth of India's 6.5 million power looms, and is one of India's largest power loom hubs, providing direct employment to a million people. 'Only 20 per cent of these (Bhiwandi's looms) are running today,' said Mannan Siddiqui, president of Bhiwandi Textile Mills Association. '*Notebandi ne humko paanch saal peeche fek diya* (Demonetization has set us back by five years),' said Asad